

My Faith Story

My faith life started when my parents had me baptized. I then continued to go to Sunday school and regular church services in my home town of Richland, Washington. Then after a few years my family and I moved out of Washington here to St. Peter, Minnesota where we have now lived for five years. I had my first communion here in St. Peter and am now taking confirmation at Trinity Lutheran.

Now that you know the condensed version of my faith life I would like to branch out on a few topics of my faith journey. Let's start with how my family has helped me along my faith journey. As I said before, my parents had me baptized at a Lutheran church when I was an infant, and prodded me along in my Sunday school activities, though one of my fondest memories of a small child was at the church: every once in a while the church hosted a take-a-part night where families would bring a broken or non-functioning device, like a toaster or a calculator, and would exchange with another family and take apart the device with a wide assortment of tools though usually mallets and hammers. And while this activity was not extremely religious, it did start a bond between me and the church.

One of the most important things that my parents did for me though was baptizing me. Through this act they forged an agreement with God that I was His child, and now I'm following through with my parents union between me and God by going through Confirmation and telling everyone that I believe in God, And because I believe in God that makes me a Christian and, of course, it makes a difference in how I live my life. I think that it makes me a better person, that it makes me a kinder, more empathetic person. And, because I'm a Christian, I can use a powerful tool when I serve God. That tool is prayer; prayer is a link to God that I can use to ask Him for forgiveness for some wrong that I have done, for advice on how to explain His teachings to others, or just to talk and unburden myself from the day's stress and work. While I think that I will be able to serve Christ, I don't think that I will be speaking in front of thousands or even hundreds; I see myself talking to small groups of people, five to six at the most, and trying to discuss or teach bits of the Bible.

The last thing that I want to talk about is Jesus; to me He is God's son, God made man, and an approachable form of God. Jesus can and will listen to my problems and give advice from the heart. Then there is Jesus' death and resurrection. This also showed a little of the man side of Jesus because He asked God if He really had to die the night before His crucifixion. But, for creation, this was a large stepping stone, because Jesus died for our sins so a sinner would not be doomed to hell for a single sin but, if he had faith in God, would have eternal life in heaven. Now I'd like to finish my story with a single statement, I believe in God the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost.